

Stephen Galatti

<https://afs.foundation/the-afs-legacy/stephen-galatti/>

Stephen Galatti was born in New Jersey, where his widely-traveled father had settled his family, having come to the US to head the New York office of the great international merchant-shippers, Ralli Brothers, involved in the cotton trade.

Steve was sent away to St. Mark's School, which prepared him for Harvard where he gained fame as the quarterback of the varsity football team. Henceforth he would belong to a powerful new network of prestigious school alumni.

After working for Ralli Brothers in London and Calcutta, and after the war broke out, briefly at the American Embassy in London, he came to Paris in August of 1915 to volunteer for the American Ambulance's new Field Service.

He was first assigned to SSU3 in Alsace and then was summoned back to Paris to become Piatt Andrew's "right hand man". When AFS was absorbed by the U.S. Army Ambulance Service in late 1917, both were given officers' commissions – by the war's end, "Doc" holding the rank of colonel, and Steve, major.

After the war, Steve returned to New York's financial district, where he eventually found work as a stockbroker. By the time WW2 broke out "Doc" had died, and it was up to Steve to reactivate the Field Service. He revived Henry Sleeper's support network in the US, moving its HQ from Boston to the premises of the New York Cotton Exchange – 60 Beaver Street – where his father had worked for so many years.

Steve then shepherded the revived ambulance service through many fields, with troops of many origins – both managing the network and assuming Doc's role of working efficiently with high government officials.

This time, AFS would carry on after the war, finding a new field of service as the conflicts of armed warfare metamorphosed into Cold War battles for minds and hearts. Under Galatti's guidance, AFS's network of "Old Boys" would be "feminized" by a new group of women staff and volunteers overseeing the adventures in foreign lands of boys – and now girls. Henceforth, AFS would champion a new cause – international understanding – through a worldwide, family-based network with, at the heart of it all, the Patriarch, Steve Galatti.



https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stephen_Galatti

Stephen Galatti (August 6, 1888 — July 13, 1964) was for many years the Director General of the [AFS, American Field Service](#). He transformed the AFS from a volunteer medical corps during World Wars I and II into an international educational exchange service that has profoundly transformed the lives of thousands of young people around the world.

Born on August 6, 1888, in [Monmouth Beach, New Jersey](#), he was a graduate of [St. Mark's School](#) and [Harvard College](#), he quarterbacked the Harvard football team.

Before [World War I](#) he began a career in banking in New York and Paris; following the war he returned to private life with the New York firm of [Paine Webber](#). He first joined the [American Field Service](#) in 1915 and served as second in command to the founder and first director of AFS, A. Piatt Andrew. In [World War I](#), the AFS played a major role in supplying ambulance drivers to the Franco-German front, and many drivers were killed. Following the war, the AFS became dormant except for limited scholarship aid for studies in France.

In 1935 Stephen Galatti became the Director General of the AFS. When [World War II](#) broke out, Galatti summoned veterans of World War I to his side. He re-established AFS in 1939 as the Germans invaded Poland then turned on France, England, and Russia. Despite American [isolationism](#), Galatti organized and equipped the first unit of the AFS, and subsequently served through the war as a Director-General with the rank of Colonel.

Searching for a role for the AFS following the war, he founded the Scholarship Program (AFSIS) in 1946, and then led the AFS as its president for the rest of his life, over time transforming it from an auxiliary medical corps for wartime into an international educational exchange service with tens of thousands of volunteers worldwide.

During his lifetime, Stephen Galatti received the [Croix de Guerre](#) and the post of Chevalier of the [Legion of Honor](#), Commander of the [Order of the British Empire](#), the [Medal of Freedom](#), the posts of Officer of the [Order of Orange-Nassau](#) and [Verdienstkreuz erster Klasse](#) (Bundesrepublik Deutschland), and [honorary MA](#) from [Yale](#), and honorary [LL.D.](#) from the [University at Buffalo](#) and from [Harvard](#).